

Background guide

UNHRC (TFS MUN)

- By The Chair Of UNHRC Committee Joshana and The Co-Chair of UNHRC Tharun

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Letter from the Executive Board

TFS Model United Nations, Executive Board

Greetings delegates,

We are delighted to welcome you to the United Nations Human Rights Council at the TFS Model United Nations!

This year's agenda focuses on **protecting children from war zones**. We are confident in your abilities and cannot wait to see the thoughtful solutions you bring to this critical issue.

As we prepare for JMUN, we encourage you to partner with fellow delegates, conduct accurate research, stay updated with the facts, and develop detailed, realistic solutions. Your strong research, creative ideas, and active participation will help the committee work effectively toward upholding the rights and protection of children affected by armed conflict.

If you need any clarifications, guidance, or assistance, the Executive Board is here to support you.

With your energy and commitment, we can make this a truly memorable JMUN. We look forward to the debates, discussions, and the resolutions you will shape.

Good luck, delegates! We believe in your success.

Sincerely,

Honourable chair of the MUN

TFS Model United Nations

Executive Board

What is the UNHRC and the aim of the committee?

“Protecting Children From War Zones”- agenda

The United Nations Human Rights Council (UNHRC) is the principal intergovernmental body within the United Nations system dedicated to the promotion and protection of human rights worldwide. Composed of 47 Member States elected by the General Assembly, it serves as a vital platform for dialogue, accountability, and collective action against human rights violations. The Council examines urgent situations, adopts resolutions, appoints independent experts and special rapporteurs, and conducts the Universal Periodic Review to hold all countries to their human rights commitments.

At TFS Model United Nations, the committee will focus on the critical agenda of **protecting children from war zones**. Armed conflicts leave children uniquely vulnerable — exposed to killing and maiming, recruitment into armed groups, sexual violence, abduction, attacks on schools and hospitals, and the denial of humanitarian assistance. Through rigorous debate and collaborative problem-solving, delegates will explore ways to strengthen international legal frameworks, improve monitoring and accountability mechanisms, ensure better protection and reintegration of affected children, and promote lasting solutions that uphold the rights, dignity, and future of every child caught in conflict.



Delegatory Houses in the Committee:

1. Western European and Others Group (WEOG)

Countries in this group are traditionally strong advocates for robust human rights standards and international humanitarian law. On the agenda of protecting children from war zones, they often push for stronger accountability, better monitoring of the six grave violations, and concrete measures to prevent recruitment, attacks on schools, and denial of aid.

2. Eastern European Group

Delegations from this group bring valuable perspectives shaped by both historical and contemporary experiences of conflict. They can contribute by supporting practical solutions for child protection, rehabilitation, and the importance of upholding international law in situations of armed conflict.

3. Latin American and Caribbean Group (GRULAC)

This group has a strong tradition of championing children's rights and peace-building. On this agenda, they often emphasize prevention, reintegration of child victims, education in emergencies, and the need for inclusive, rights-based approaches to protecting children in war zones.

4. African Group

Many African states have direct experience with the impact of armed conflict on children. Their voices are essential in highlighting on-ground realities, supporting community-based protection, strengthening national capacities, and ensuring that solutions remain practical and context-sensitive.

5. Asia-Pacific Group

This diverse group brings a wide range of experiences and priorities. Delegations can contribute by balancing strong child-protection norms with practical implementation challenges, regional cooperation, and the importance of sustainable solutions for children affected by conflict.

Rules and Procedures of the Committee The committee proceedings will be as follows:-

1. Roll Call - Each delegate will be noted through a roll call. As a delegate, note that you must respond when your name is called out.

2. Speech on Agenda - Each delegate will give a speech based on the views of the country that they are representatives of.

3. General Speakers' List(GSL) – After the speeches, a General Speakers' List will be established. Delegates may add their names to the GSL to express their country's perspectives, propose ideas, and contribute to the overall discussion. The GSL will continue throughout the committee unless suspended or closed by a motion.

4. Moderated Caucus – Delegates may motion for a moderated caucus to focus discussion on a specific sub-topic of the agenda. The Chair will set the speaking time and total duration. During moderated caucuses, delegates will speak in an organised manner to ensure smooth debate.

5. Unmoderated Caucus – Delegates may also motion for an unmoderated caucus, allowing free movement and informal negotiation. This is the time used for drafting solutions, forming blocs, and collaborating with other delegations.

6. Working Papers – Once ideas are formed, delegates may begin drafting working papers that outline proposed solutions. These must reflect the views of the sponsoring countries and should be submitted to the Executive Board for approval.

7. Draft Resolutions – Approved working papers may then be converted into draft resolutions. Delegates will debate and refine these documents through amendments and further negotiation.

8. Voting Procedure – Once debate has concluded, the committee will move into voting procedure. Delegates must follow the rules set by the Chair while voting on draft resolutions, amendments, and procedural motions. The resolution that passes will become the committee's final outcome.

These are the points Delegates can call upon throughout the session to address issues :

→ **Point of Information** - Raises an issue about a delegate's speech

→ **Point of Personal Privilege** - Raises an unrelated attribute of the committee to be altered → **Point of Parliamentary Inquiry** - Clarifies doubt about committee rules and regulations.

→ **Point of Order** - Points out issues in a delegate's speech.

→ **Right to Reply**- raises a want to reply to a delegate that has misrepresented a country

Points of Preparation:

UNHRC – Protecting Children from War Zones

- **Understand the agenda thoroughly** Research the six grave violations against children in armed conflict (killing & maiming, recruitment & use, sexual violence, abduction, attacks on schools/hospitals, and denial of humanitarian access).
- **Know your country's position** Study your assigned country's official stance, voting history, treaties it has signed (especially the Convention on the Rights of the Child and its Optional Protocol on children in armed conflict), and any relevant national policies or statements.
- **Study key international frameworks** Familiarise yourself with Security Council resolutions on Children and Armed Conflict, reports of the Special Representative of the Secretary-General, and previous Human Rights Council resolutions on the rights of the child.
- **Research current conflict situations** Be aware of major ongoing conflicts where children are severely affected and understand the different challenges in each context.
- **Prepare constructive solutions** Develop realistic, well-researched proposals on prevention, accountability, protection of schools and hospitals, reintegration of child soldiers, and improving humanitarian access.

Proper and Resourceful Websites for Research:

1. <https://childrenandarmedconflict.un.org>
2. <https://www.ohchr.org/en/children/children-and-armed-conflict>
3. <https://www.securitycouncilreport.org/un-documents/children-and-armed-conflict/>
4. <https://www.unicef.org>
5. <https://watchlist.org>
6. <https://www.icrc.org>
7. https://www.un.org/en/ga/search/view_doc.asp?symbol=A/RES/54/263
8. <https://www.ohchr.org/en/instruments-mechanisms/instruments/convention-rights-child>

Thank You!

Let's make this session a memorable one and hope you enjoy being a delegate of our committee!